

Week 3.1

Grammar: reported speech

Listening: to a gossip columnist

Pronunciation: silent letters - consonants

Grammar: reported speech with optional backshifting

Work in pairs. Who do you think are five of the most famous people in the world? Try to think of a variety of famous people, not just entertainers. Be prepared to share your ideas with the class.

Work in groups. Do you think the famous people you chose in the previous exercise are different or special compared to ordinary people? If so, how?

Grammar: reported speech

Read the magazine article. Was each person's experience of fame positive or negative? Why?

The artist Andy Warhol once said that everyone would be famous for 15 minutes. Here we look at two people who have had their 15 minutes of fame and what the experience meant to them. STEVE JENNINGS was just 17 when he appeared as Des in the popular TV series Angels back in the 90s. He became famous overnight, but Steve said no one had told him what to expect and how to deal with it. Although he enjoyed aspects of his celebrity, he admitted that he would do things differently if he became famous now, and confessed that he had had to get help to deal with the pressures of fame. And then there's TOM REYNOLDS from San Diego, who unexpectedly inherited a fortune from an uncle he never knew and became famous when the news was widely publicised by reporters. Within a short time, Tom had spent the whole of his inheritance and ended up living on the streets.

Answer the questions.

1. In reported speech, what usually happens to the verb which comes after the reporting verb? Does the tense change?
2. Now look at the reporting verbs you underlined in the article. Does the verb that follows the reporting verb always change form in reported speech?

Fill in the missing spaces with the correct form of the verb.

1. Direct: 'I hadn't thought about what fame would really be like.'
Reported: He admitted that he _____ about what fame would really be like.

2. Direct: 'I may never work in television again.'
Reported: He suggested (that) he _____ never work in television again.

3. Direct: 'Would you do things differently?'
Reported: She asked if he _____ do things differently

Rewrite the direct quotes in reported speech with the reporting verbs in brackets.

1. Andrew: 'I would like to see Lily Allen in concert.' (said)
2. Entertainment Weekly: 'Pharrel Williams may perform at the new stadium.'
(reported)
3. Clare: 'Will I see some celebrities during my holiday in Los Angeles?' (asked)
4. Security guard: 'You have to leave your cameras at the door.' (told us)
5. Dylan: 'I had never used Twitter before I went to university.' (said)

Listening: to a gossip columnist

Work in pairs and discuss the questions.

1. Does being a celebrity mean the same as being famous?
2. Do you think all famous people are celebrities?

Read the questions below. Then, listen to the audio. Be prepared to discuss your answers to the questions with the class.

1. According to the gossip columnist, what is the difference between A-, B- and C-list celebrities?
2. Think of the famous people you brainstormed earlier in the lesson. In your opinion, what categories do they belong to?
3. Think of some famous people in your country. According to the definitions of A-, B- and C-list celebrities, which category would each person be in?



Try to complete the phrases with words from the box. Then, check your answers to the listening text.

1. _____ a world record
2. _____ a global company
3. _____ a fortune
4. _____ a best-selling novel
5. _____ a cure for a disease
6. _____ a scandal
7. _____ a new invention/idea

break ~ cause ~ come up with ~ discover ~ inherit ~ run ~ write



What other ways can a person become famous?

Pronunciation: silent letters - consonants

Look at the words below. What happens to the specified consonant sound in each one when it is pronounced? Listen and check your ideas.

b: numb, debt, doubt

k: known, knot

g: foreign, sign

p: psychology

h: rhyme, hours, when

l: could, should



Copy the words below into your notebook. Then, listen and underline the silent consonant sound in each word. .

1. comb
2. designer
3. ghost
4. honest
5. knee
6. knife
7. knock
8. resign



Grammar: reported speech with optional
backshifting

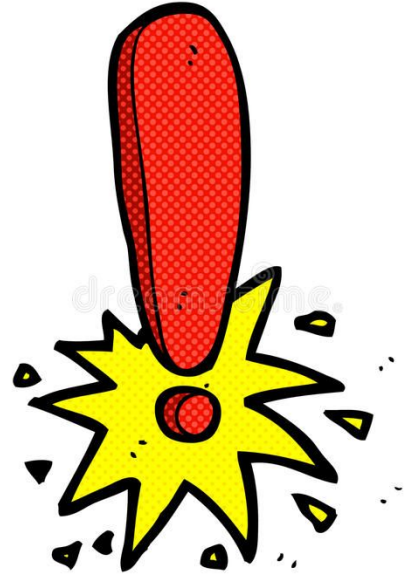
Consider the following examples. Are they grammatically correct? Do they sound right to you?

- In an interview, Beyoncé revealed that she is happy with her level of fame.
- Elon Musk said he'll continue to fight Twitter in court.
- David Beckham told journalists he deeply respects the memory of the Queen.

Back-shifting is optional
when reporting

- a. a general truth.
- b. something that is true at the
moment of reporting.
- c. future possibilities or plans.

Back-shifting is
necessary
when reporting
something
that is no longer true.



Look at the pairs of sentences below. For each pair, which is correct: a, b or both?

1. a) He said he doesn't like being in the spotlight.
b) He said he didn't like being in the spotlight.
2. a) At first, he claimed he can't see a strong likeness.
b) At first, he claimed he couldn't see a strong likeness.
3. a) He said he will never get used to being famous, but he seems to like it now.
b) He said he would never get used to being famous, but he seems to like it now.

**Rewrite the direct speech as reported speech with and without back-shifting.
In one example, only back-shifting is possible.**

1) John: 'They are holding an Oscars party.'

John announced...

John announced...

2) Nadia (yesterday): 'I'm really excited about the concert this evening.'

Nadia told us...

Nadia told us...

3) Lecturer: 'Technological advances will change the way we watch films.'

The lecturer declared...

The lecturer declared...

Role play

Work in pairs. Choose a roleplay card. Do the roleplay, take notes and then swap roles. Afterwards, work with a new partner. Report on what you asked your partner in the roleplay and what their answers were.

Student A

You are a reporter. Student B is a lookalike of a famous person. Prepare four or five questions to ask them about their experience as a lookalike. Take notes.

Student B

You are a lookalike of a famous person. Student A is a reporter who is going to interview you. To prepare, think about what it's like to be a lookalike.

A little bit more grammar practice 😈

Rewrite the direct speech as reported speech in two different ways. Use the verbs in brackets.

1. The manager: 'You have to wear a tie if you want to get into the club.' (said)
2. Rachel: 'You have to be very self-confident to be an actor.' (commented)
3. Vicky: 'Will the film industry change a lot in the near future?' (asked)
4. Anton: 'I've seen lots of celebrities around here.' (revealed)
5. Sonia: 'I can help you find an agent.' (told me)